

JING XIANG XU

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Dear Y-Intercept Recruiting Team,

I am applying for the Quantitative Researcher Intern position at your Central office. I am a Master of Engineering student in Financial Engineering at Cornell (graduating December 2027) and completed my BSc in Mathematics with First Class Honours at the University of Hong Kong this June; I hold an IANG visa with unrestricted right to work in Hong Kong and can commit to the full three-to-six-month internship from summer 2027.

The role's focus — designing and testing predictive statistical models, mining unconventional data for new signals, and monitoring strategy performance and risk — mirrors how I already work. At Dymon Asia Capital in Hong Kong I predicted Hang Seng Composite and Tech Index constituent changes before official announcements: translating published methodologies into point-in-time eligibility, liquidity and buffer logic, building an auditable Python pipeline over FactSet, ERD and HKEX filings, and achieving an 82.6% action-level hit rate (185/224) across three live rebalances in leakage-controlled evaluation. At Rivermap I mined company-description and revenue-segment data into tradable themes using a two-stage semantic retrieval pipeline (BGE embeddings, then LLM-based refinement). At Nine Martingale I built a factor-backtesting framework (annualized return +6%, Sharpe +0.3) and corrected a 60-day dividend-event data lag, raising information coefficient by 0.02 — hands-on experience with exactly the data-integrity and performance-analysis work your researchers do daily.

Your requirements align directly: probability and statistics (HKU mathematics, Cornell convex optimization and machine learning coursework), machine learning and pattern recognition (embedding retrieval and LLM pipelines in production internships), and Python and SQL as my primary tools. Just as importantly, Hong Kong is my home market — I studied and interned here, work natively in Mandarin and English, and want to build my career in the city where Y-Intercept trades. I would welcome the chance to contribute to your team and am available for interviews at any time.

Sincerely,

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